

Everwood Analytics

Employee Handbook and Operating Policies

Purpose of this sample document

This fictional handbook was created as a clean, text-based PDF for testing a retrieval-augmented generation application. It contains specific policies, dates, amounts, approval rules, and procedures so a document AI system can answer questions with source citations.

Document metadata

Document Type	Internal employee handbook
Company	Everwood Analytics, Inc.
Effective Date	January 1, 2026
Last Updated	June 20, 2026
Owner	People Operations and Security Team
Audience	Employees, contractors, and approved temporary staff

Quick reference questions to test

- How much PTO do employees receive after their first year?
- What is the remote work policy?
- When do expense reports need to be submitted?
- What should an employee do if a laptop is lost?
- What purchases require finance approval?

1. Paid Time Off Policy

Full-time employees receive 10 days of paid time off during their first year of employment. After completing one full year of service, employees receive 15 days of paid time off per calendar year. After three years of continuous service, employees receive 20 days of paid time off per calendar year.

PTO requests should be submitted at least 10 business days before the requested start date. Managers should approve or deny PTO requests within three business days. Emergency absences should be reported to a manager as soon as reasonably possible.

Unused PTO may be carried over into the next calendar year, up to a maximum of 40 hours. Any unused PTO above 40 hours expires on December 31 unless state law requires a different treatment.

Employees may not take more than 10 consecutive business days of PTO without written approval from both their direct manager and People Operations.

2. Remote Work and Office Attendance

Everwood Analytics operates as a hybrid-first company. Employees assigned to a local office are expected to work from the office on Tuesdays and Thursdays unless their manager approves an exception.

Remote work is allowed on Mondays, Wednesdays, and Fridays for eligible employees whose role can be performed remotely. Employees working remotely must be reachable on Slack and email during core collaboration hours from 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM local time.

Employees may work from another state for up to 20 business days per calendar year. Work from another country requires written approval from Legal, People Operations, and the employee's department leader at least 30 days in advance.

Team meetings, customer calls, and security reviews may require attendance even on normally remote days.

3. Expense Reimbursement

Employees must submit expense reports within 30 calendar days of the transaction date. Reports submitted after 30 days may be denied unless the delay was caused by travel, illness, or a documented system issue.

Receipts are required for all expenses over \$25. Meals during approved business travel are reimbursable up to \$75 per day. Lodging must be reasonable for the destination city and business purpose.

Any single purchase over \$500 requires manager approval before the purchase is made. Any software, subscription, or vendor contract over \$1,000 requires approval from Finance and Security before purchase.

Personal expenses, gift cards, traffic tickets, airline upgrades, and entertainment that is not tied to a documented business purpose are not reimbursable.

4. Information Security

All employees must use company-managed devices for company work. Personal laptops may not be used for customer data, production systems, or source code unless Security grants a written exception.

Passwords must be stored in the approved password manager. Multi-factor authentication is required for email, code repositories, cloud services, HR systems, and financial systems.

If a laptop, phone, badge, or hardware security key is lost or stolen, the employee must report the incident to Security within one hour of discovery. The report should include the device type, last known location, approximate time of loss, and whether customer data may have been accessible.

Customer data may not be copied into public AI tools, personal cloud drives, or unapproved collaboration platforms. Redacted or synthetic data should be used for demos and testing whenever possible.

5. AI Tool Usage Policy

Employees may use approved AI tools for drafting, brainstorming, summarizing public information, writing test data, and improving internal documentation. Employees remain responsible for reviewing AI-generated output before using it in business communications or production work.

Confidential customer information, unreleased financial results, private employee information, authentication secrets, and proprietary source code may not be submitted to unapproved AI tools.

When using AI-generated code, engineers must review the output, run tests, and verify license and security implications before opening a pull request. AI output should be treated as a draft, not as an authority.

High-impact decisions involving hiring, compensation, customer credit, legal conclusions, or security enforcement must include human review and may not be delegated entirely to an automated system.

6. Incident Reporting and Escalation

Operational incidents should be reported in the #incidents Slack channel and assigned an incident commander. Security incidents should also be reported to security@everwood.example.

A severity 1 incident includes production downtime affecting all customers, suspected compromise of customer data, or loss of access to a critical system. Severity 1 incidents require executive notification within 30 minutes.

A severity 2 incident includes partial service degradation, a failed deployment that affects a subset of customers, or a security alert that requires investigation but has no confirmed data exposure.

Every severity 1 or severity 2 incident must have a written post-incident review within five business days. The review should include timeline, root cause, customer impact, remediation steps, and follow-up owners.

7. Performance Reviews and Promotions

Formal performance reviews occur twice per year, in June and December. Employees receive written feedback from their manager and may provide self-review notes before the review meeting.

Promotion nominations are reviewed by department leaders during the December review cycle. A promotion requires evidence of consistent performance at the next level, business impact, and demonstration of company values.

Managers should provide direct feedback throughout the year rather than saving concerns for the formal review cycle. Employees may request a growth plan at any time.

8. Separation and Equipment Return

Departing employees must return company laptops, monitors, badges, hardware keys, and other company-owned equipment within seven calendar days of their final working day.

Access to company systems is removed at the end of the final working day unless Legal or Security requires earlier deactivation. Final expense reports must be submitted within 10 calendar days after separation.

Confidential information remains protected after employment ends. Departing employees may not retain customer records, source code, internal strategy documents, employee records, or vendor contracts.

Appendix A: Test Answers Hidden in the Document

This appendix intentionally repeats several facts in a compact form so retrieval systems can be tested for consistency. The correct PTO answer is 15 days after one year of service. The correct office attendance answer is Tuesdays and Thursdays for local office employees. The correct expense deadline is 30 calendar days after the transaction. The correct lost laptop reporting deadline is within one hour of discovery. The correct approval threshold for a single purchase is over \$500 for manager approval, and over \$1,000 for software, subscription, or vendor contracts requiring Finance and Security approval.

Appendix B: Sample Evaluation Prompts

- What are the PTO carryover limits?
- Which days are employees expected to be in the office?
- Can employees work from another country?
- What is the daily meal reimbursement limit during approved business travel?
- What is the escalation rule for severity 1 incidents?
- When are formal performance reviews conducted?
- How soon must departing employees return company equipment?

End of sample document.